

W4 Hypothetical & Conditional

WHAT THIS FRAME MEANS

This frame asks you to think about what would happen if conditions changed. You are not describing what is — you are projecting what would be under a different scenario. Good speakers at this level reason carefully about possibility and probability, not just imagination.

WHAT TO TRY

- Set up a clear condition: if X were to happen...
- Project a likely outcome based on reasoning, not just opinion
- Acknowledge uncertainty — use language that shows you are estimating, not claiming certainty
- Consider what would happen if the condition did not occur

SENTENCE STARTERS

- "If this policy were implemented, the likely result would be..."
- "Were this to happen, institutions would probably respond by..."
- "If the condition changes, we would expect..."
- "Without this regulation, the risk is that..."
- "It is plausible that... though the outcome depends on..."

EXAMPLE IN ACTION

"If central banks adopted digital currencies, the most likely short-term effect would be a reduction in cash transactions — particularly for small purchases. Over time, this would probably reduce demand for physical banking infrastructure. However, the outcome depends heavily on whether citizens trust the government with direct visibility into their spending, which is not guaranteed."